EXPERIMENT 10

Getting Started with Zoho Creator: Account Setup and Building a Form-Based Application

Subject: No-Code Application Development

Aim

To explore the Zoho Creator development interface and design a basic form-based business application.

Objectives

- Understand the account and application creation process.
- Design fields with appropriate data types and validation.
- Test form submission and record storage.

Selected Application

Employee Leave Request application. Form fields: Employee Name, Employee ID, Department, Leave Type, Start Date, End Date, Reason and Status.

Requirements / Tools

- Access to Zoho Creator (trial/account availability and eligibility may vary)
- Web browser and internet connectivity
- Fictional test records; no real personal data required

No-Code Connection

Zoho Creator is a low-code platform. Form fields and validation rules can be configured visually, while optional Deluge scripts extend behavior. This exercise emphasizes no-code configuration first.

Illustrative Business Scenario

Create a Leave Request form with employee, department, start date, end date, leave type, reason and status fields.

Experimental Procedure

Follow these steps in the designated simulator, browser or visual app builder. Menu locations and available features may vary by product version and account plan.

1. Sign in through the official Zoho Creator website using an authorized account.

2. Choose the option to create a new application, then create a blank application named Leave Management.

3. Add a form called Leave Request with name, text, dropdown, date and multi-line fields.

4. Mark required fields; define Leave Type choices such as Casual, Sick and Other.

5. Set Status to Pending by default where supported and apply relevant input validation.

6. Preview the form and submit fictional sample entries; verify their appearance in the record list.

No-Code Application Perspective

- Identify the user action and the visual interface element involved (form, page, workflow or report).
- Trace the data movement from input to processing to stored record, report or notification.
- Identify configuration that replaces traditional hand-written code and note where scripting might still be required.
- Check whether the experiment can be repeated using sample records and documented settings.

Evidence to Collect

- Screenshot of the configured screen, topology, tool or application.
- A short observation table showing input, action and output.
- One successful test and one failed or exceptional test with expected behavior.

Form fields and types

Field	Suggested type	Validation
Employee Name	Single line	Required
Employee ID	Single line	Required/unique if applicable
Department	Dropdown	Select one
Leave Type	Dropdown	Casual / Sick / Other
Start and End Date	Date	End date not before start
Reason	Multi-line	Required
Status	Dropdown	Pending by default

Sample test cases

Case	Expected result
Valid form data	Record saved
Required field blank	Submission blocked
End date before start	Validation message if rule configured

Interpretation / Analysis

- Form fields determine the quality and structure of stored records.
- Required fields and consistent dropdown choices reduce incomplete or inconsistent submissions.
- The precise UI labels and features may differ between current Zoho Creator versions.

Evaluation Against a No-Code Solution

- Ease of creation: determine how much is configured visually rather than programmed.
- Data and integration: identify where records, connections or services are created and managed.
- Governance: consider role permissions, traceability and safe data handling.
- Limitations: identify any feature that may require paid access, external services or custom logic.

Verification / Test Cases

Suggested Test Record

Test	Input / action	Expected observation
Normal test	Valid sample values and supported action	Expected successful output
Boundary test	Missing value, invalid input or empty data	Validation or clear empty state
Access test	Unapproved user attempts restricted action	Access limited according to role
Repeatability	Re-run same valid example	Consistent output or explain differences

Observation Notes

During the practical session, replace the illustrative outcomes with actual observed results. Include the software/platform name, version if known, screenshots, and any errors encountered.

Results

The planned application has a structured form and test cases. Record the actual application URL and test outcome after creating it in Zoho Creator.

Conclusion

Zoho Creator provides a visual route for implementing data collection, validation and record storage without building a full web backend.

No-Code Learning Outcome

This experiment links the technical concept to a practical no-code application development workflow. It highlights visual configuration, user experience, data handling and safe validation rather than treating the exercise as conventional full-code software development.

Precautions

- Use only fictional sample records for classroom demonstrations; avoid exposing passwords, tokens, employee information or real contact details.
- Record your own screenshots, observed outputs and deviations after executing the experiment. The examples below are models, not verified live results.
- Check access rights before sharing or publishing an app, report, workflow or externally reachable service.